

Exploratory Analysis: Artist Dataset

Research Team - Mafia Culture

June 9, 2026

1 Introduction

This report describes the artist dataset of the *Neomelodic Corpus* (**190 artists**) and documents three aspects: biographical metadata coverage, the demographic structure of the sample, and the genre’s geographic rootedness. The correct reading remains descriptive: the report measures the composition of the available artist sample after cleaning and integration, not the full universe of neomelodic music. This layer also remains the upstream demographic base of the canonical layers used in the *tracks* and *lyrics* reports.

2 Data Quality and Cleaning Strategy

Rationale: Before interpreting gender, generation, and geographic origin, it is necessary to clarify how the dataset was stabilized and which inference steps were introduced.

Measures: The pipeline combined three interventions: rule-based recoding of region and province from `birth_place`, correction of homonym cases in enriched records, and generation interpolation for profiles lacking an observed birth year but with a usable discographic trajectory.

Interpretation: The final result is a nearly complete dataset for the key variables. The important methodological point is that final quality does not derive from a simple mechanical merge of external sources: it depends on a sequence of explicit corrections, especially on geography and generation.

2.1 Final Coverage

Table 1: Final Variable Coverage after Inference and Cleaning

Variable	Missing Values (N)	Percentage (%)
Gender	0	0.0%
Generation	2	1.1%
Birth Region	0	0.0%
Birth Province	0	0.0%

Notes: The count treats only empty strings or “Unknown” as missing. The province code “NA” indicates Naples and is not classified as missing.

Stata/Python code: `01_exploratory_artists.do`, lines 75–81, performs the final missingness check on the cleaned dataset; `export_artist_report_tables.py` materializes the LaTeX table. The province code NA is correctly treated as Naples, not as missing.

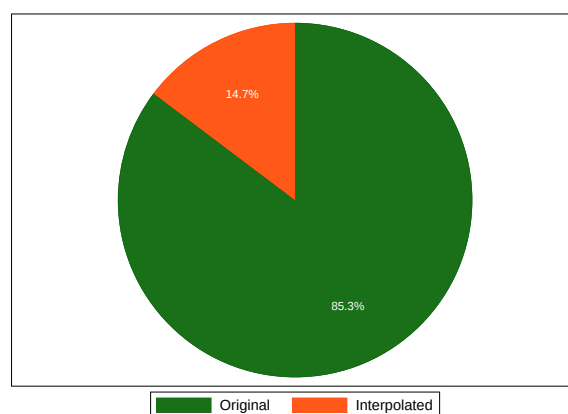
2.2 Generation Interpolation

Rationale: Since a non-negligible share of artists does not have a verified year of birth, the report must make explicit the weight of interpolation in the final dataset.

Measures: The variable `gen_interpolated` flags cases in which the generational cohort was imputed using the year of the first observed release. In the final dataset, interpolated cases amount to **28 out of 190 (14.7%)**.

Interpretation: Interpolation allows the dataset to remain analytically usable, but it introduces an important distinction between observed and estimated cohorts. This does not invalidate the report; it does, however, require caution, especially for the smaller cohorts.

Figure 1: Share of Interpolated Generations



Notes: The chart distinguishes profiles with observed generation from those classified via debut year. Interpolation concerns 14.7% of the sample.

Stata code: `01_exploratory_artists.do`, lines 171–178. `graph pie, over(gen_interpolated) ...`

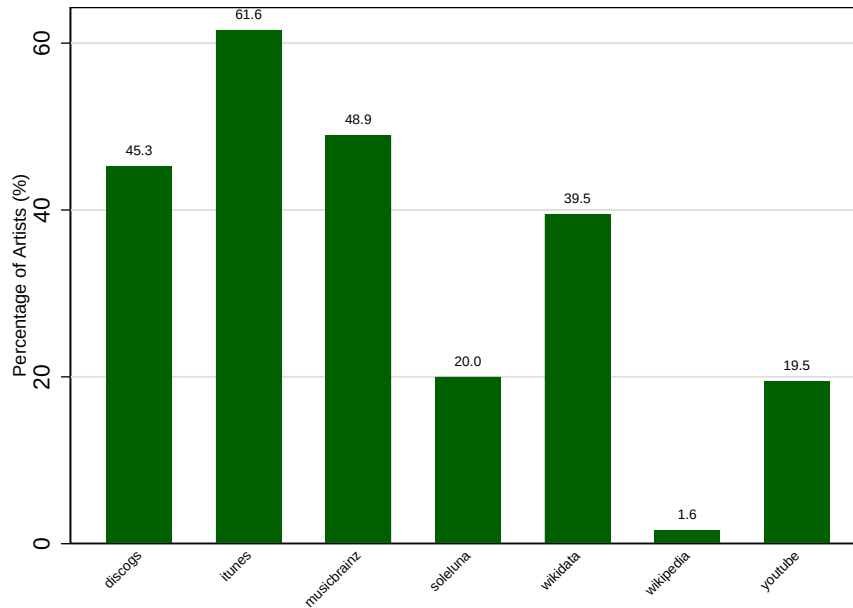
3 Source Coverage

Rationale: Coverage by platform helps assess how much the dataset depends on a few central sources and how much it is instead supported by multi-source triangulation.

Measures: Presence/absence of the main biographical sources for each artist across the full sample of 190 profiles.

Interpretation: iTunes (**61.6%**), MusicBrainz (**48.9%**), Discogs (**45.3%**), and Wikipedia (**39.5%**) provide the broadest coverage. Wikipedia (**1.6%**) captures only the subset of artists with much stronger encyclopedic relevance. This figure measures breadth of platform coverage, not uniform quality of the biographical information.

Figure 2: Coverage of Biographical Sources by Artist



Notes: Percentages indicate the share of artists present on each platform. The bars do not sum to 100% because an artist may appear in multiple sources.

Stata code: 01_exploratory_artists.do, lines 85–108. `gen has_itunes = strpos(sources,"iTunes")>0; collapse (mean) has_...; reshape long has_;`
`graph bar has_`
`...`

4 Demographic Structure

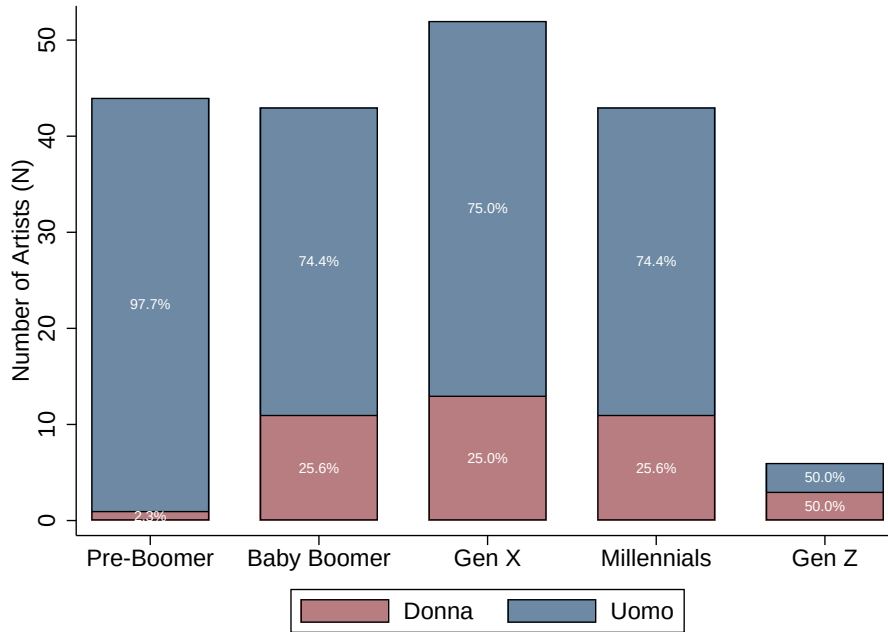
4.1 Distribution by Gender and Generation

Rationale: Composition by cohort and gender makes it possible to describe the genre’s continuity and the persistent gender imbalance in the artist sample.

Measures: Absolute counts by generational cohort and sex. Internal labels report the gender composition within each cohort in percentage terms. The final dataset contains **149 men** and **41 women**. The main cohorts are relatively balanced in overall size (*Pre-Boomer* 44, *Baby Boomer* 43, *Gen X* 52, *Millennial* 43), whereas *Gen Z* includes only **6** cases.

Interpretation: Male predominance is structural across all cohorts. The figure is useful for showing the persistence of the gender gap and the sample’s intergenerational continuity, but it does not justify strong readings of *Gen Z*, which remains too small to support substantive conclusions.

Figure 3: Generational Distribution by Gender



Notes: The Y-axis reports the absolute number of artists; internal labels indicate the percentage gender share within each cohort. Gen Z should be read only descriptively because of its small size.

Stata code: 01_exploratory_artists.do, lines 115–149. `collapse (sum) count, by(gen_order sex); reshape wide count ...; twoway (bar ...) (scatter mlabel(...)) ...`

5 Geographic Rootedness

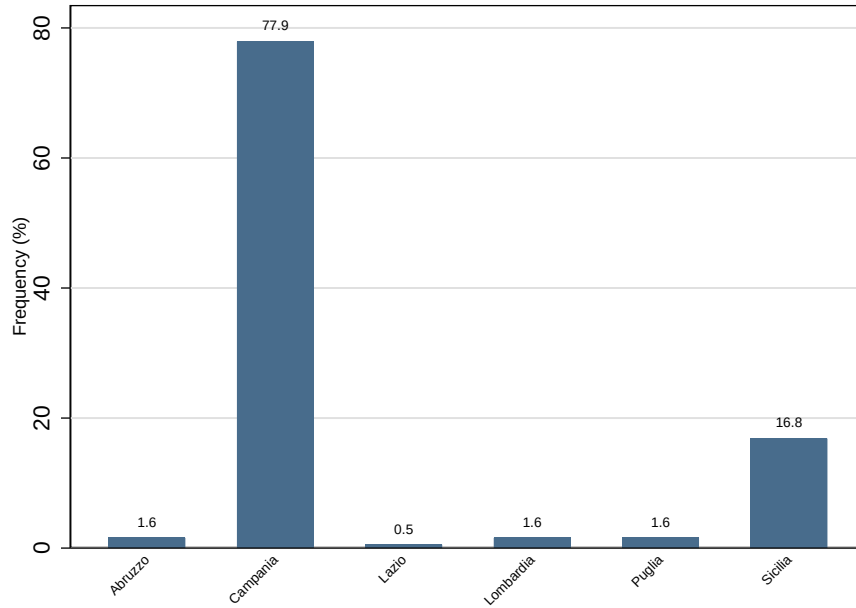
5.1 Regional Distribution

Rationale: The regional distribution serves to verify whether the artist sample confirms the historical territorial centrality of Campania and Sicily.

Measures: Percentage of artists by birth region in the final cleaned dataset.

Interpretation: The sample is heavily concentrated in **Campania (77.9%)** and **Sicily (16.8%)**. Other regions appear with minimal frequencies and should be interpreted as peripheral or diaspora cases. This supports the idea of a genre strongly rooted in the historical southern poles, but the figure remains descriptive and depends on the upstream rule-based geographic recoding.

Figure 4: Distribution of Artists by Region of Birth



Notes: Campania clearly dominates the sample, followed by Sicily. The remaining regions have very small counts.

Stata code: 01_exploratory_artists.do, lines 151–159. `graph bar (percent),
over(birth.region, ...)`

5.2 Artists outside the Core Regions

Rationale: Isolating artists born outside Campania and Sicily helps distinguish the genre’s territorial core from peripheral cases.

Measures: Descriptive list of artists with `birth.region` different from Campania and Sicily in the final cleaned dataset.

Interpretation: The non-core share is very small. For this reason, the following table has a purely documentary function: it serves to make the residual cases transparent, not to support an autonomous interpretation of the genre’s national spread.

Table 2: List of Artists Born outside Campania and Sicily

Artist Name	Birth City	Region
mimmo moreno	Penne	Abruzzo
mimmo sarti	Penne	Abruzzo
mimmo taurino	Penne	Abruzzo
amedeo remi	Roma	Lazio
gaetano setola	Bergamo	Lombardia
gigione	Busto Arsizio	Lombardia
gianluigi	Nembro	Lombardia
kekko dany	Bari	Puglia
tommy parisi	Bari	Puglia
nino delli	Foggia	Puglia

Note: Table generated automatically from the final cleaned dataset; it has a purely descriptive function.

Stata/Python code: 01_exploratory_artists.do, lines 183–186, saves the cleaned individual dataset; export_artist_report_tables.py automatically filters profiles outside Campania and Sicily and writes the LaTeX table.

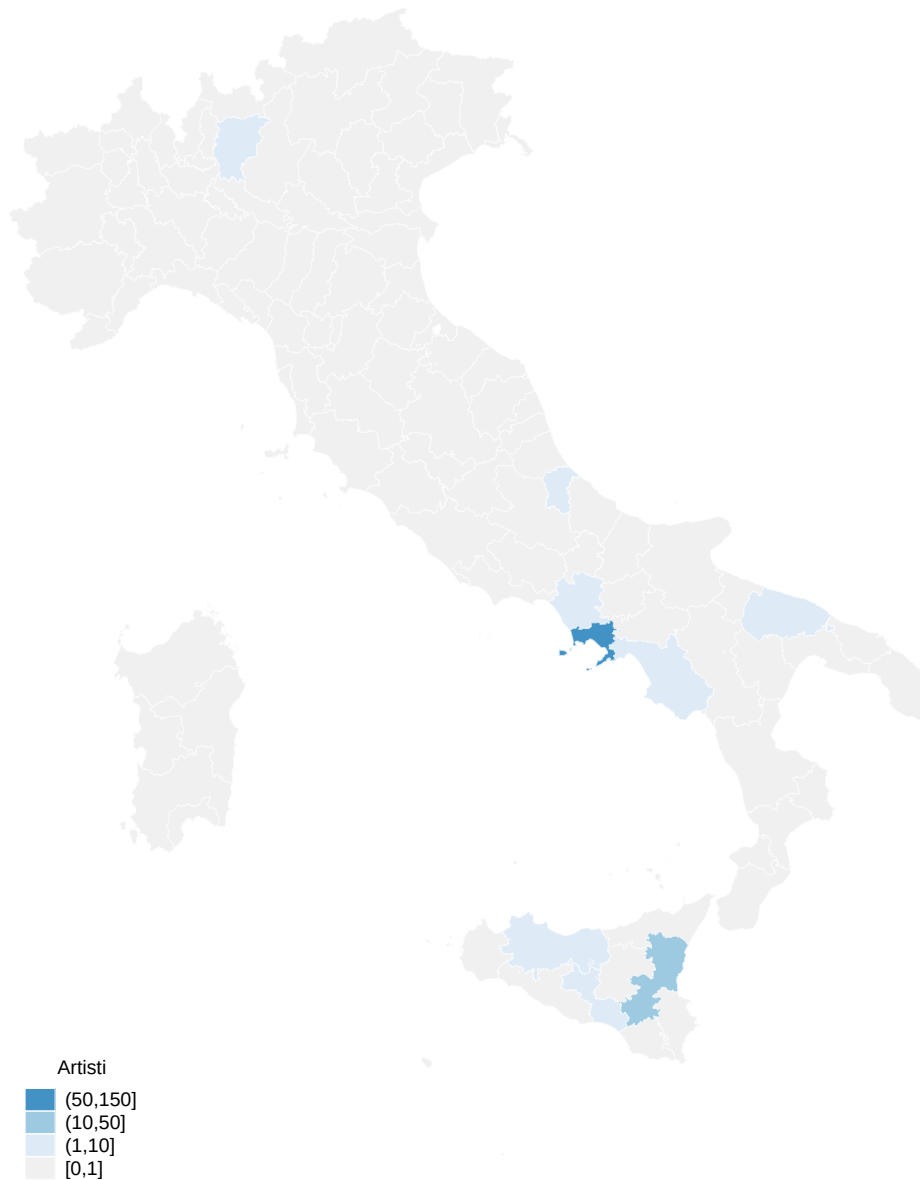
5.3 Provincial Map

Rationale: The provincial map makes it possible to move below the regional level and show where the genre is actually concentrated in territorial space.

Measures: Absolute frequencies of artists by province of birth, visualized with `spmap`.

Interpretation: Naples emerges as the sample’s absolute epicenter, followed by the main Sicilian poles. The map is consistent with the strong regional concentration observed above and adds spatial granularity rather than any further causal inference.

Figure 5: Distribution of Artists' Provinces of Birth



Notes: The coloring indicates the absolute number of artists by province of birth. The gradient confirms the centrality of Naples and the main Sicilian poles.

Stata code: 01_exploratory_artists.do, lines 188–216. collapse (sum)
artist_count=count_val, by(birth_province); spmap artist_count using italy_coord.dta,
id(id) ...

6 Conclusions

After geographic recoding, homonym correction, and limited generation interpolation, the artist dataset returns a coherent picture: strong male prevalence, continuity of the genre across four main cohorts, and a very strong territorial rootedness in Campania and Sicily. The two limits to keep explicitly in mind are the share of interpolated generations (**14.7%**) and the too-small size of *Gen Z*, which does not support robust substantive readings.